

ANNUAL CURRICULUM

Teens Class

Ages 12 – 15

Jiu-Jitsu — Monthly Technical Curriculum

Prepared by the Team's Technical Direction

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Introduction: Why This Content, at This Age?

The 12-to-15 age range marks the transition between kids' and adult Jiu-Jitsu. Physically, students already have enough coordination, strength, and motor maturity to sustain longer and more complex technical sequences; cognitively, they're now able to understand and chain together concepts — such as transitions between guards, counters, and guard recovery — that previously had to be simplified.

That's why the program moves from closed guard and basic sweeps (January through March) to the modern open-guard repertoire — De La Riva, spider, X guard, K guard, 50/50, and berimbolo (May through July) — and finishes with high-intensity takedowns and attacks (August through December). This progression respects the teenage learning curve: first it consolidates the base (closing distance, control, and fundamental submissions), then it adds mobility variables, and finally it demands decision-making under pressure.

For this age group, technical content is also a tool for personal development: discipline, the patience to repeat details, respect for the rules and hierarchy of the mat, and confidence built gradually and concretely — every month, students realize they've mastered something they hadn't before. The review weeks (April, August, and December) are intentional: they consolidate what's been taught before increasing complexity, avoiding gaps in technical development.

This document serves as a reference guide for the team's instructors: each month is divided into weekly classes, with the techniques and themes to be covered, ensuring that all Teens classes across the team follow the same pedagogical path throughout the year.

01 JANUARY

Week 1

- Double leg takedown + closed guard
- Kimura submission
- Kimura sweep
- Guard break + knee-cut pass

Week 2

- Closed guard pull
- Closed guard submissions: cross collar choke, triangle choke, and armbar

Week 3

- Closed guard pull
- Standing guard break + pass
- Sweep using feet on the hips or tripod sweep

Week 4

- Quick pass while the opponent pulls guard
- Closed guard sweeps: pendulum sweep and scissor sweep

02 FEBRUARY

Week 1

- Harai Goshi
- Submission from side control
- Knee on belly + mount

Week 2

- Osoto Gari
- Armbar off the Osoto Gari takedown

Week 3

- Double leg takedown
- Toreando pass (1, 2, 3)
- Submissions from mount

Week 4

- Takedown defense (sprawl)
- Guard recovery from side control
- Mount escape

03 MARCH

Week 1

- Half guard (traditional)
- Pass, sweep, and back take

Week 2

- Half guard (reverse)
- Pass, sweep, and back take

Week 3

- Half guard (deep)
- How to enter it?
- Pass, sweep, and back take

Week 4

- Half guard (lockdown)
- How to enter it?
- Pass, sweep, and back take

04 APRIL

Week 1

- Single leg takedown, entries
- Single leg defense
- Back take from the single leg

Week 2

- Ippon Seoi Nage
- North-south
- North-south submission
- Back take
- Guard recoveries

Week 3

- Kata Guruma
- Turtle position + back take
- Submission from turtle
- Turtle escape

Week 4

- Review of previous months

05 MAY

Week 1

- De La Riva guard pull
- Pass, sweep, and back take from De La Riva

Week 2

- Spider guard
- Pass, sweep, and submission from spider guard

Week 3

- Transition from De La Riva to reverse De La Riva
- Pass, sweep, and back take from reverse De La Riva

Week 4

- Transition from spider guard to one leg guard
- Pass, sweep, and back take from one leg guard

06 JUNE

Week 1

- Double guard pull
- Berimbolo work (leg drag and back take)

Week 2

- Transition from one leg guard to X guard
- Pass, sweep, and back take from X guard

Week 3

- K guard
- K guard transitions

Week 4

- Lapel guard
- Pass, sweep, and back take from lapel guard

07 JULY

Week 1

- Lapel guard
- Pass, sweep, and back take from lapel guard

Week 2

- Lapel guard
- Pass, sweep, and back take from lapel guard

Week 3

- Berimbolo from De La Riva
- Back submissions

Week 4

- 50/50
- Pass, sweep, and back take from 50/50

08 AUGUST

Week 1

- Snap down
- Submissions from turtle / front headlock
- Guard recovery

Week 2

- Kouchi Gari
- Knee-cut pass
- Armbar from side control

Week 3

- Ouchi Gari
- Uchimata
- Takedown drilling and specifics

Week 4

- Review of previous months

09 SEPTEMBER

Week 1

- "Crazy Dog" guard pass
- Back take from Crazy Dog

Week 2

- Leg drag pass
- Leg drag defense
- Back take from leg drag

Week 3

- Collar drag from butterfly guard
- Loop choke from butterfly guard

Week 4

- Drilling and specifics

10 OCTOBER

Week 1

- "Aerial" attacks when the opponent pulls guard:
- Cartwheel pass
- Jumping-over-the-head pass
- "Flying" pass

Week 2

- Armbar
- Triangle choke

Week 3

- Quick attacks from the guard pull:
- Armbar
- Triangle choke

Week 4

- Fake guard pull + leg grab
- Guard pull with leg grab

11 NOVEMBER

Week 1

- Heel-control sweep off the guard pull
- Tripod sweep off the guard pull
- Triangle or armbar from the tripod sweep

Week 2

- Complete drills:
- Toreando pass + back take + submission
- Collar drag + turtle + back take + submission

Week 3

- Complete drills:
- De La Riva + X guard (discarding the leg) + takedown, pass, and finish

Week 4

- Complete drill:
- De La Riva + X guard (discarding the leg) + standing back take, finished with a bow and arrow choke

12 DECEMBER

Week 1

- Defense work:
- Armbar
- Triangle choke
- Choke

Week 2

- Mount
- Back control

Week 3

- Weeks 3 and 4 open for review of previous months